

Australia and NZ Weekly 16 March 2026

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Friday edition: analysis and forecasts for this week's key releases.



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In this week's edition:

Economic Insight: RBA to hike 0.25% in both March and May.

The Week That Was: A time for caution.

Focus on New Zealand: RBNZ to stand pat as inflation pushes higher.

Forecast Update: additional cash rate hike of 0.25ppt expected in March. Core inflation upgraded.

For the week ahead:

Australia: RBA policy decision, labour force statistics, RBA financial stability review, Westpac-MI Leading Index.

New Zealand: Q4 GDP, Q4 current account balance, selected consumer prices, Q1 consumer confidence.

China: Retail sales, industrial production, fixed asset investment.

Eurozone: ECB policy decision, CPI, trade balance.

United Kingdom: BoE policy decision.

Canada: BoC policy decision.

United States: FOMC policy decision, PPIs, industrial production, leading index, factory orders.

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